

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

FRIDAY, AUGUST 29, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Standoff at CDC stokes confusion



Susan Monarez testifies during her confirmation hearing for CDC director June 25 in Washington. **KAYLA BARTKOWSKI/GETTY**

Agency chief defies RFK Jr. push to oust her; 4 officials quit

By Mike Stobbe, Amanda Seitz and Chris Megerian
Associated Press

NEW YORK — The nation's top public health agency was left reeling and leaderless as the White House works to expel its hand-picked director from the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention and three senior officials were

escorted from its headquarters Thursday.

The turmoil triggered rare bipartisan alarm as President Donald Trump's health secretary, Robert F. Kennedy Jr., tries to advance anti-vaccine policies that are contradicted by decades of scientific research.

The chaos comes weeks before a key advisory committee, which

Kennedy has reshaped with vaccine skeptics, is expected to meet to issue new recommendations on immunizations.

Two Republican senators called for congressional oversight and some Democrats said Kennedy should be fired. He is scheduled to testify Sept. 4 on Capitol Hill.

Kennedy has not explained the decision to oust Susan Monarez

as CDC director less than a month after she was sworn in, but warned that more turnover could be coming.

"There's a lot of trouble at the CDC and it's going to require getting rid of some people over the long term, in order for us to change the institutional culture," Kennedy said at a news conference in Texas.

The White House has only said that Monarez was "not aligned

Turn to CDC, Page 9



ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS

Pilgrim Mother in Des Plaines

The faithful attend a Mass before the unveiling of a sculpture of Our Lady of Guadalupe, right, on Wednesday at the Shrine of Our Lady of Guadalupe in Des Plaines. The statue of the Pilgrim Mother, a hyperrealistic sculpture blessed at the Basilica of Our Lady of Guadalupe in Mexico City, is on the first U.S. stop of its international spiritual tour. The statue will be on display in the St. Joseph Chapel at Our Lady of Guadalupe in Des Plaines until Sept. 30. The visit is part of the observance of the upcoming 500th anniversary of the apparitions at Tepeyac in Mexico. **Chicagoland, Page 2**



Officials say immigration crackdown is coming

Chicago's top cop says he wants officers to take least hostile role possible

By Jake Sheridan and Alice Yin
Chicago Tribune

Chicago police Superintendent Larry Snelling said Thursday he will not direct his officers to obstruct a potential federal crackdown on the streets but expressed hope that some communication with his department could lower tensions in a city already on edge.

The city's top cop joined Mayor Brandon Johnson to brief reporters on the rumored influx of federal troops and law enforcement as President Donald Trump threatens to target Chicago next for a military occupation.

The two city leaders said they had not heard from the White House, though Trump's border czar Tom Homan told reporters in Washington, D.C., Thursday that preparations were underway for an immigration crackdown in Chicago, and reports said it could commence as soon as next week.

But Snelling repeated that his door is open for the feds to

inform him about any deployment, suggesting he wanted Chicago police to take on the least hostile role possible in order to mitigate some of the "chaos" that could erupt.

"If they're here, communication between the CPD and the National Guard would be most helpful, because I think that's where we can find some type of balance," Snelling said. "There's no need at this point to create an adversarial environment which could lead to violence."

A Chicago police spokesperson clarified later that Snelling was talking about protesters and

protecting First Amendment rights when speaking against fomenting "an adversarial environment."

Homan also confirmed Thursday that the administration was considering using the Naval Station Great Lakes base north of Chicago to host federal Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents ahead of immigration raids.

"There's discussions about that, yes," Homan told reporters outside the White House.

He declined to say whether

Turn to Crackdown, Page 4

Mexican Independence Day parade in Pilsen will go on

Organizers: Celebration won't be stopped by deportation fears

By Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

As President Donald Trump considers bolstering immigration enforcement efforts in Chicago as early as next week, organizers of the Pilsen Mexican Independence Day Parade said Thursday the upcoming celebration will go on despite deportation fears.

"We are not going to be stopped

from celebrating our roots, our heritage, our culture," said Vicky Lugo, secretary of the United Merchants of Pilsen Chamber of Commerce.

Lugo spoke Thursday morning at a news conference at Pilsen's Plaza Tenochtitlán, where she and other organizers encouraged the community to attend the 24th annual parade, scheduled for Sept. 6 at noon. She said there are folkloric dancers, traditional music and "very colorful" floats to look forward to.

Turn to Parade, Page 4



Community members wave flags during the Pilsen Mexican Independence Day Parade on Sept. 9, 2023. Organizers of the 2025 parade said that the upcoming celebration will go on despite the Trump administration's immigration crackdown. **TALIA SPRAGUE/TRIBUNE**

Walgreens' acquisition by private equity final

Sycamore Partners takes control, says HQ to stay in Chicago area

By Lisa Schencker
Chicago Tribune

Walgreens Boots Alliance — which grew from humble beginnings in Chicago into one of the nation's largest retail pharmacy chains — has officially become a private company, with private equity firm Sycamore Partners announcing Thursday that it has completed its acquisition of the business.

The acquisition follows an announcement in March that Sycamore would buy the company for about \$10 billion. Sycamore is a New York-based private-equity firm specializing in retail, consumer and distribution-related investments.

Walgreens, The Boots Group, Shields Health Solutions, CareCentrix and VillageMD will now operate as separate, standalone companies.

Walgreens headquarters will remain in the Chicago area, according to the company. The company's headquarters has long been in Deerfield.

Some experts have worried that the deal could lead to more layoffs and store closures, making it difficult for some patients to get their medications. Walgreens spokesperson Jonathon Hosea declined to comment Thursday on whether the company expects layoffs and said he had no updates on whether more store closures are possible. The company declined to make leaders of Walgreens or Sycamore available for an interview Thursday.

A new CEO has been appointed

Turn to Walgreens, Page 2

INSIDE

Tool uses AI to help doctors ID syndrome

Researchers at Endeavor Health, Northwestern create AI tool to help identify a dangerous respiratory condition. **Business**

Fighting Irish look to build on 2024 season

Can Jeremiah Love win the Heisman — and how will CJ Carr handle early tests? Five questions for Notre Dame. **Chicago Sports**

TODAY'S WEATHER

High **70**
Low **56**



Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 241
© Chicago Tribune

